

Jaime Polanco-Jimenez

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics, Pontificia Universidad Javeriana & KU Leuven

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Research Interests

Human Capital Development, Organizational Behavior, Managerial Decision-Making, Applied Microeconomics, and Economics of Education.

Education

KU Leuven <i>Ph.D. in Economics (Joint Degree)</i>	Aug 2020 – March 2026 <i>Leuven, Belgium</i>
Pontificia Universidad Javeriana <i>Ph.D. in Economics (Joint Degree)</i>	Aug 2020 – May 2026 <i>Bogota, Colombia</i>
Pontificia Universidad Javeriana <i>M.S. in Economics</i>	Nov 2024 <i>Bogota, Colombia</i>
Udmurt State University <i>M.S. in Economics</i>	Sep 2018 – Jul 2020 <i>Izhevsk, Russia</i>
Udmurt State University <i>M.S. in Oil and Gas Engineering</i>	Sep 2017 – Jul 2019 <i>Izhevsk, Russia</i>
University of America <i>Bachelor in Oil and Gas Engineering</i>	2016 <i>Bogota, Colombia</i>

Publications

- Polanco-Jimenez, J. (2025). *Road to the Future: Identifying Impacts of Roads on Education in Colombia*. *International Journal of Educational Development*, 114, 103173.
- Polanco-Jimenez, J., & De Witte, K. (2025). *Factors Influencing STEM Participation and Effective Intervention Strategies*. NESET Report, Luxembourg Publication Office of the European Union. doi: 10.2766/4854833.

Working Papers

- **(Job Market Paper)** Polanco-Jimenez, J. & De Witte, K. (2025). *The Tailoring Premium: How AI Design Unlocks Student Engagement and Learning*. Under Peer-Review at *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*.
- Lozano, J. & Polanco-Jimenez, J. (2025). *Financial Literacy and Business Success: Evidence from an RCT in Colombia*.
- Polanco-Jimenez, J., De Witte, K., & Bernal, G. L. (2025). *Does Coeducation Close the STEM Gap? Evidence from a Single-Sex Schooling Transition in Colombia*. Under Peer-Review at *Journal of Development Economics*.

- Polanco-Jimenez, J., & Posso, C. (2025). *Black Gold and Dull Minds: The Impact of Oil Exploration Announcements on Education in Colombia*.
- Castañeda, B. & Polanco-Jimenez, J. (2025). *Local Oil Shocks and Student Trajectories: Evidence from Colombian Post-Secondary Education Choices*.

Academic and Research Experience

London School of Economics and Political Science <i>Visiting Fellow at WISPPRH</i>	Since March 2026
KU Leuven - LEER, Belgium <i>Postdoctoral Researcher</i>	Since March 2026
Pontificia Universidad Javeriana <i>Graduate Teaching Assistant – Advanced Econometrics I & II</i>	Oct 2022 – 2024 <i>Instructor: Adrian Garlati</i>
Banco de la República, Colombia <i>Research Assistant</i>	Aug 2022 – Mar 2023 <i>Joint research on macroeconomic shocks and human capital.</i>
Pontificia Universidad Javeriana <i>Research Assistant</i>	Oct 2020 – Aug 2021 <i>Laboratorio Economía de la Educación (LEE)</i>
Bogotá Summer School in Economics <i>Graduate Teaching Assistant</i>	2021 <i>Real Analysis (Instructor: Andres Carvajal)</i>

Extension and Professional Services

Servinformación <i>Consultant – Senior Data Scientist</i>	Oct 2022 – 2024 <i>Bogotá, Colombia</i>
Fiscal Observatory, Universidad Javeriana <i>Consultant</i>	Aug 2023 – Dec 2023 <i>Policy and fiscal analyses.</i>
Secretaría de Salud de Bogotá <i>Data Scientist</i>	Oct 2020 – Aug 2022 <i>Analytical support during public health operations.</i>

RCT Registrations + Ongoing Project

- Polanco-Jimenez, J. & Sevilla, A. (2026). "Evaluating an AI-Powered Research Development Tool for Academic Productivity and Well-being." *AEA RCT Registry*. January 28. <https://doi.org/10.1257/rct.17749-2.0>
- Polanco-Jimenez, J. & De Witte, K. (2025). "A Randomized Controlled Trial of an AI-Based Guidance Tool for Post-Secondary Planning." *AEA RCT Registry*. [doi:10.1257/rct.17212-1.1](https://doi.org/10.1257/rct.17212-1.1)
- Polanco-Jimenez, J. & De Witte, K. (2024). "The Tailoring Premium: How AI Design Unlocks Student Engagement and Learning." *AEA RCT Registry*. [doi:10.1257/rct.15266-1.1](https://doi.org/10.1257/rct.15266-1.1)

Scholarships and Grants

- Google Cloud Platform Research Credits Program, 2024–2026. Awarded \$5,000 USD.

- Doctoral Fellowship, Pontificia Universidad Javeriana, 2020. Merit-based full scholarship.
- Russian Government Scholarship, Udmurt State University, 2018. International grant.

Table 1: Technical Skills and Professional Certifications

Category	Details
Languages	Spanish (Native), English (Fluent), Russian (Fluent)
Programming	Python, R, Stata, SQL, $\LaTeX$
Methodologies	Causal Inference (RCTs, DiD, RDD), Applied Econometrics, Machine Learning, Cloud Computing (GCP)
Certifications	Google Cloud Professional Machine Learning Engineer; Google Cloud Professional Data Engineer

Notes: Certifications verified by Google Cloud Professional program. Methodological expertise focuses on causal identification in human capital research.